

Go for Orange!

To earn your Orange Band, you will need to show that you have learned:

- How to solve more difficult Go problems
- Understand the three main corner openings
- Routinely build 'frameworks' and 'bases'
- Explain the concept of a 'vital point'
- Win at least 2 out of 4 games against an AI opponent

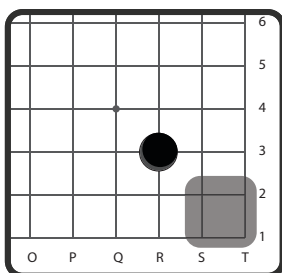
Win against the AI? Impossible!

AI has become a useful tool. Ask your parents to sign up (for free) at ai-sensei.com and you can play an AI opponent that's appropriate for your level. If you win 2 out of 4 at 21k level during Go club, you're well on your way.

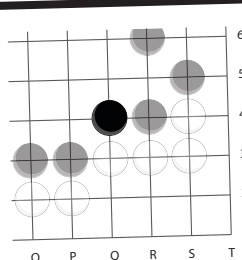


Corners in the opening

Your first few moves in a game of Go are very important. You can start securing points in the corners right away! There are three main corner moves you can play while you're learning, which will take you a long way.

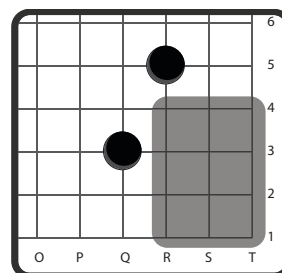


The '3-3' point (three lines in from each edge) is a secure way to get a small amount of territory.



The '4-4' point does not get territory, as your opponent can invade at the 3-3 point at any time. However, it is

still a popular place to play. If an invasion occurs, you will get a strong position facing the rest of the board in exchange. You can see one outcome shaded in here.



The '3-4' point is a good compromise. You get lots of territory, but it takes a second move to secure it.

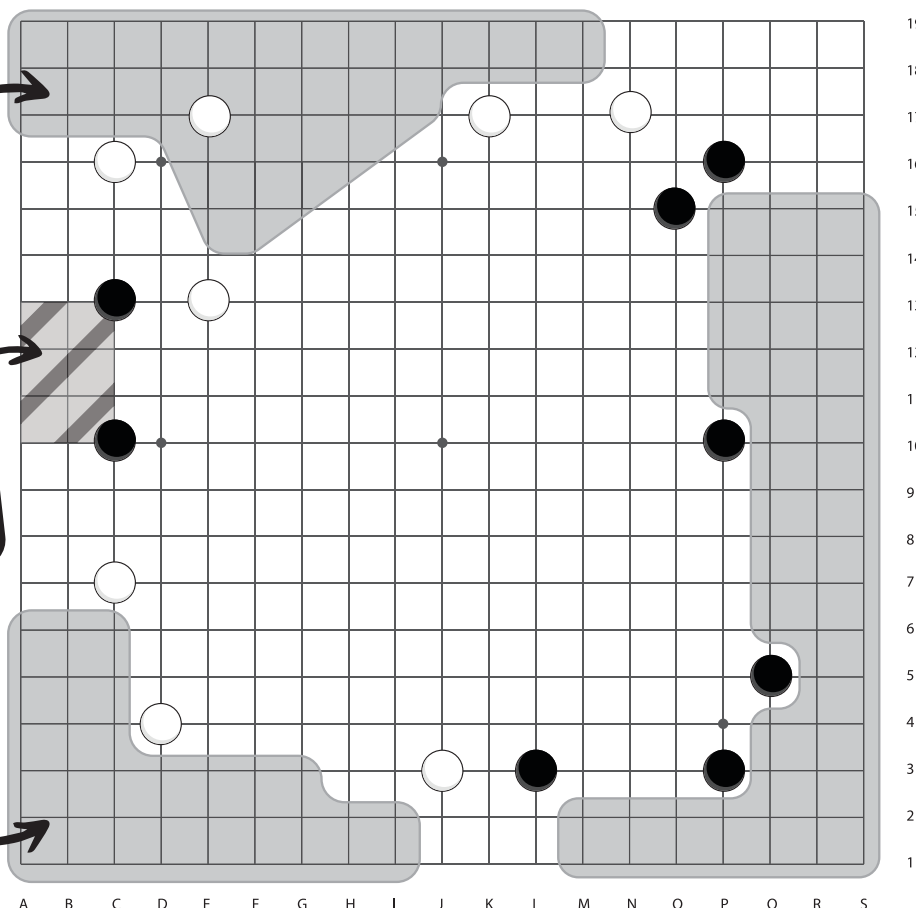
Frameworks and bases

During the opening period of each game, spreading out is essential for success. Placing key stones around the board to 'sketch out' areas that you'd like to secure later is important. This kind of framework is called a 'moyo'. At this stage of the game, every move is very valuable.

This is an example of a framework, or 'moyo'. The white stones sketch out an area that they would like to claim later. Black needs to try and reduce this before white finishes it. Can you think of a good place to play? Perhaps along that diagonal line, where it is weakest?

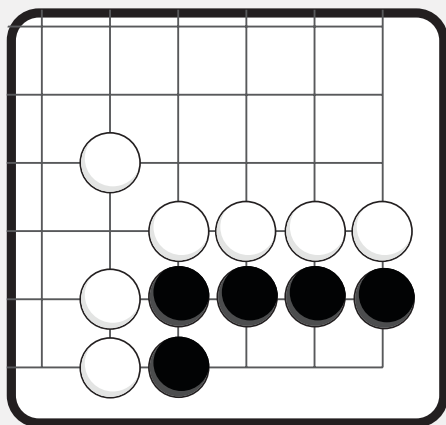
This is a 'base'. Black has played in a way that gives them a good chance to form two eyes within a space that white was hoping to claim later. Two stones played like this can be very strong.

Black and white have both sketched out good frameworks for future territory. Which do you think is more solid? If you were black, is there a place you can invade white's lower corner?

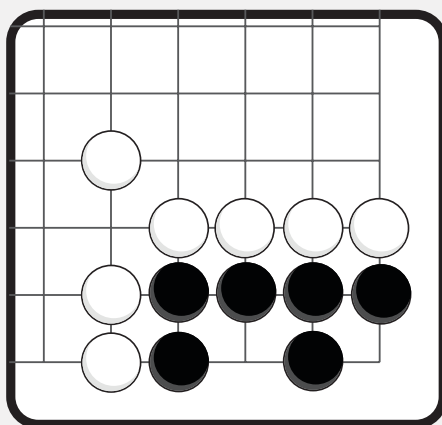


Vital points – how to be a deadly Go assassin

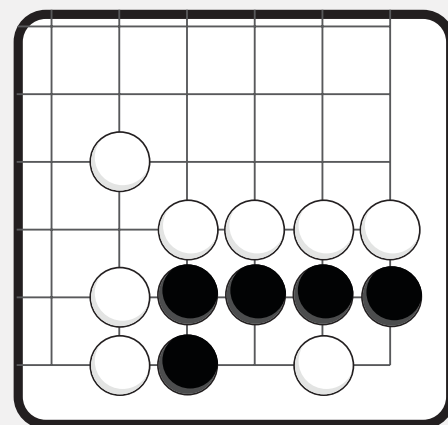
In every game of Go, there are times where the survival of a group will depend on who plays at one really important point. This is called the 'vital point', and you can effectively kill a group with a single stone by preventing it forming two eyes. Here's a simple example:



Black's group is in real trouble here! It only has one eye, so eventually white can kill it. Black really wants to save the group by splitting that eye into two.



Black would like to play here. It allows the group to survive. This move is played at the 'vital' point.



If white plays the 'vital point' instead, black can no longer form two eyes. Even if black captures this white stone, they are still only left with one eye. Eventually white will kill this black group. After white plays the vital point, both players can focus elsewhere on the board – there is no hope for black to survive!

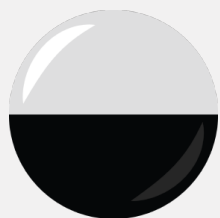
Motivation and tools



Hikaru No Go

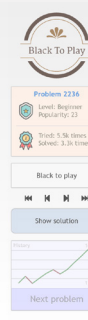
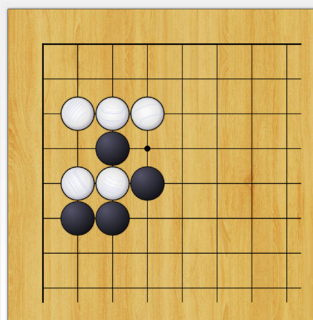
If you only do one thing on this whole sheet, look up Hikaru No Go. Available as a Manga series on Kindle, or as Anime at wcoflix.tv/anime/hikaru-no-go, this is a critically acclaimed story of a kid who suddenly discovers the Ghost of an ancient Go master. We follow his journey as he gets stronger and more powerful – for many people, this is how they learned about Go.

Genuinely gripping, fun and easy to enjoy. You won't regret reading or watching this!



Online-go.com

This is the main way to play more games online. If you're serious about getting better, you can play friends and other people here. Take part in tournaments, increase your rank and access learning tools!



blacktoplay.com

A simple place to get Go problems, which adjust themselves to your level. Each time you get a correct answer, it gives you a slightly harder problem. Get one wrong and it gets easier!



Gomagic.org

An incredibly good collection of interactive courses and tools. Easy to follow, you can start with beginner courses and progress through their guided learning. They also have the 'skill tree', which takes you through sets of Go problems that teach all the different techniques and skills you'll need.

Beginner content is free, with paid options if you want to progress further.